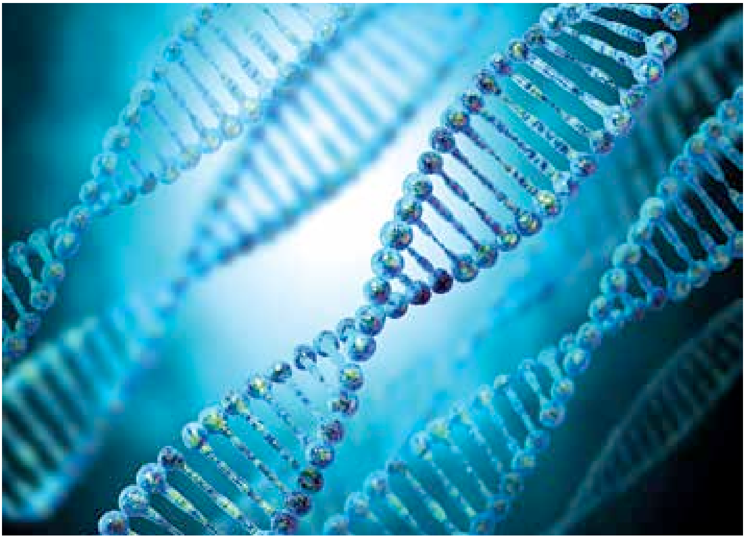
First, the position of the defenders at the time of the shot is not accounted for. Sure, metrics like the speed of the play indicate the defensive pressure to an extent, but the relative positions of the defenders themselves are almost always crucial in determining how likely the attacking team is to score.

Second, it doesn't take into account the skill of the player. There will obviously be a far greater chance of Lionel Messi scoring a goal from 20 yards out rather than Andy Carroll. Furthermore, forwards are significantly more likely to score than defenders, and so on.

Third, its results are skewed when the model considers the very best clubs in Europe, such as Barcelona, Bayern Munich and Real Madrid. Their actual goals scored are far higher than their expected values. This may be explained by their playing style, which tends to yield better chances than usual, and also simply by the high skill level of their players. This sort of qualitative description intrinsic to the game is difficult to factor in immediately into the equation.

Part 2: Data Therapy – Big Data In Healthcare

Another industry that has benefitted from the computing boom has been healthcare. As reception desks started including computers, patient records



Sequencing the human genome may hold the key to the holy grail of healthcare – personalised medicine.